

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Baristas and Cafe Staff English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Baristas, cafe counter staff, and coffee pickup staff.

All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Taking a precise drink order

Clarify a familiar word that can describe several order details.

02 Comparing drinks without overclaiming

Explain this cafe's options without presenting a universal recipe.

03 Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

Clarify sweetness and allergy questions as separate issues.

04 Managing the queue and pickup

Use a second identifier when names are duplicated.

05 Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Acknowledge the error and confirm the replacement details.

06 Discussing coffee beans for home

Distinguish grind requirements and flavor descriptions from assumptions.

07 Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

State included items and additional charges before the customer commits.

08 Handing over the bar and till

Hand over orders, supplies, and a till question without merging them.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Taking a precise drink order

Clarify a familiar word that can describe several order details.

SITUATION

A customer says 'a regular latte.' This cafe uses regular for its middle size, but the customer might mean caffeinated coffee or the usual milk. No drink has been made. Clarify size, hot or iced, and coffee choice separately.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

espresso - A concentrated coffee drink prepared by passing hot water through finely ground coffee under pressure.

shot - A cafe's specified serving of espresso; exact size and recipe vary.

decaf - Coffee from which most caffeine has been removed; it is not necessarily caffeine-free.

dine in - An order intended to be consumed in the cafe rather than taken away.

Useful word combinations

confirm the drink size: check the selected menu size

make it decaf: request the cafe's decaffeinated coffee option

leave room: request space below the top of a filled cup

repeat the full drink: check type, size, temperature style, and changes together

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Unpack the word 'regular'

3. Notice the language

Ask one specification at a time. Decaf describes coffee, not milk or sweetness, and doesn't mean guaranteed zero caffeine.

By regular, do you mean ___?

Would you like that hot or ___?

That's a ___ latte with ___, for ___.

Compare this wording: A regular, got it.

Clearer: Do you mean our regular size, and would you like caffeinated or decaf coffee?

The check separates size from coffee choice.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: I mean your middle size, not the coffee type.

Barista: So 'regular' refers to the ____.

A. milk

B. sweetness

C. size

D. coffee type

2. Customer: Does decaf guarantee no caffeine at all?

Barista: No. It means ____.

A. coffee with every trace of caffeine removed

B. a smaller serving of regular coffee

C. regular coffee diluted with milk

D. coffee with most caffeine removed

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Regular needs three checks

The ambiguous latte order from the case.

01 • Customer: Could I have a regular latte, please, and make that one to go?

02 • Barista: By regular, do you mean our middle size or the caffeinated coffee option?

03 • Customer: The middle size. I'd actually like decaf because I've already had coffee today.

04 • Barista: Certainly. Would you like that latte hot or iced on this order?

05 • Customer: Hot, please. I didn't realize regular could refer to more than the size.

06 • Barista: It can. Which milk would you like? We have whole milk and the listed alternatives.

07 • Customer: Whole milk is fine. I don't want any syrup added to the drink.

08 • Barista: That's one middle-size hot decaf latte, whole milk, no syrup, to take away.

09 • Customer: Yes, that's everything. Please use the name Ellis when you call the order.

10 • Barista: Ellis, thank you. I'll put that name with those specifications on your ticket.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A shot is not a bigger cup

A customer asks what an extra-shot option changes.

01 • Customer: Does choosing an extra shot make the drink come in a bigger cup?

02 • Barista: No, it adds espresso under our menu option; the cup size stays the same.

03 • Customer: I want a larger drink, not extra coffee in the size I already chose.

04 • Barista: Then let's change the size rather than automatically add an extra shot to it.

05 • Customer: Thank you. What's the price difference between the small and large sizes here?

06 • Barista: The large is one dollar more. An extra shot has a separate listed charge.

07 • Customer: I'll take the large standard version, then, without choosing that extra-shot option today.

08 • Barista: Understood. Large latte, standard coffee recipe, with no separately added extra shot.

09 • Customer: And still hot with whole milk, as I said when I first ordered.

10 • Barista: Yes, those choices stay unchanged. I'll repeat the final ticket before taking payment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Leaving room is an amount request

A customer clarifies space in a filter-coffee cup.

01 • Barista: You asked me to leave room. How much space would you like for your milk?

02 • Customer: Just a little at the top, not a cup that's only half full.

03 • Barista: Thanks. Would you like the milk added here, or served separately for you?

04 • Customer: Separately, please. I'd like to decide how much to add at the table.

05 • Barista: I'll note room for milk and a separate serving, with no syrup added.

06 • Customer: Yes. This is for drinking here, so I don't need a takeaway lid.

07 • Barista: A dine-in cup, then. Is the coffee choice still the house filter?

08 • Customer: It is. I haven't changed the coffee itself, only how it's served today.

09 • Barista: Understood. House filter with room and milk separately, for here rather than takeaway.

10 • Customer: Exactly. Thank you for checking what I meant before reducing the amount too much.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Taking a precise drink order

A customer says 'a regular latte.' This cafe uses regular for its middle size, but the customer might mean caffeinated coffee or the usual milk. No drink has been made. Clarify size, hot or iced, and coffee choice separately.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you mean middle size; choose hot, decaf, and whole milk when asked.

Second round: The customer says 'the normal one' about milk. Ask for the actual milk choice.

Scenario 2 | Hot order, iced label

A customer orders a small hot decaf latte. Before payment, the screen shows small iced decaf latte. Milk choice is correct.

Role A: Barista: read the screen and correct temperature style.

Role B: Customer: confirm hot, not iced; keep the other choices.

Possible opening: I have iced on the screen, but I heard hot. Which did you want?

Success checks

- Obtain hot or iced explicitly.
- Keep decaf and size unchanged.
- Read back the corrected order.

Add a complication: The customer says 'same as before,' but the previous order isn't visible.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Comparing drinks without overclaiming

Explain this cafe's options without presenting a universal recipe.

SITUATION

In this fictional cafe, the small latte and small cappuccino both contain the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has more liquid milk. The customer wants less foam, not more caffeine. Compare the two using those facts.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

latte - An espresso drink with milk; proportions and serving styles vary by cafe.

cappuccino - An espresso-and-milk drink typically featuring a noticeable foam layer; recipes vary.

Americano - An espresso drink diluted with water according to the cafe's recipe.

filter coffee - Coffee brewed by passing water through ground coffee and a filter.

Useful word combinations

describe the milk balance: explain how milky an option tastes

compare the menu recipes: use this cafe's actual drink descriptions

offer a flavor description: describe taste without promising a personal reaction

avoid a caffeine guarantee: do not infer exact caffeine content from taste or color

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Compare the criterion the customer cares about

3. Notice the language

Ask whether 'strong' means coffee flavor, less milk, or caffeine. Local recipe facts support a comparison; they don't establish precise caffeine totals.

Both use ___, but ___ has more ___.

When you say strong, are you asking about ___?

For your preference for ___, ___ may suit you.

Compare this wording: The darker one has more caffeine.

Clearer: Color doesn't establish caffeine content; I can compare our stated recipes.

The revision replaces an unsupported inference with a bounded comparison.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: I want less foam, not extra coffee.

Barista: Compared with our small cappuccino, our small ___ has more liquid milk and less foam.

- A. latte
- B. Americano
- C. black filter coffee
- D. cappuccino

2. Barista: Both use the same espresso serving, ___ their milk textures differ.

- A. unless
- B. but
- C. because
- D. therefore

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Less foam, not more coffee

The small-drink comparison in the case.

01 • Customer: Which has more coffee, your small latte or small cappuccino? I dislike too much foam.

02 • Barista: Both use the same espresso serving here, but their milk and foam balance differs.

03 • Customer: Then choosing the latte wouldn't automatically mean ordering a different espresso amount at this cafe?

04 • Barista: Correct. Our small latte has more liquid milk, while the cappuccino has more foam.

05 • Customer: The latte sounds closer to what I mean. I want something milky, not especially foamy.

06 • Barista: Would you like the small latte, then, with its usual milk balance and no additions?

07 • Customer: Yes, please. Does a drink tasting stronger always mean it contains more caffeine?

08 • Barista: Not necessarily. Taste alone doesn't establish caffeine content, and I don't have exact figures.

09 • Customer: That's enough information. Please keep the standard coffee recipe rather than adding an extra shot.

10 • Barista: Certainly. One small latte with the standard recipe; no extra shot requested.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An Americano is not filter coffee

A customer wants the brewed-coffee option on the menu.

01 • Customer: I'd like brewed filter coffee. Is that the same menu item as an Americano?

02 • Barista: They're different here. The Americano starts with espresso and water; filter coffee uses our filter brew.

03 • Customer: I see. Which one comes from the batch you have on the counter now?

04 • Barista: The house filter comes from that batch. The Americano is a separate drink order.

05 • Customer: Then I'll choose the house filter. Is milk automatically included in the cup?

06 • Barista: No, we can offer it separately if you'd like. Would you prefer coffee alone?

07 • Customer: Coffee alone, please. I mainly wanted to avoid ordering an espresso-based drink by mistake.

08 • Barista: Understood. A small house filter, black, with no added milk or syrup on this order.

09 • Customer: That works. Could you tell me which bean is being used for today's filter?

10 • Barista: The board names today's house blend. I'll show you its current description beside the price.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Strong can mean flavor

A barista clarifies a taste preference without caffeine claims.

01 • Barista: When you ask for stronger coffee, do you mean a more pronounced flavor or more caffeine?

02 • Customer: A more pronounced flavor. I usually find my drink tastes mostly of milk.

03 • Barista: Thanks. We can compare our smaller milk drink with your usual large latte.

04 • Customer: Would that be a comparison of the milk balance rather than a guaranteed caffeine increase?

05 • Barista: Exactly. The menu descriptions can help with flavor balance, but I can't promise your perception.

06 • Customer: I'd like to hear the smaller option's description and price before changing my order.

07 • Barista: This one has less milk in our recipe and costs four dollars today.

08 • Customer: I'll try that. Please keep the standard recipe rather than invent a special strength setting.

09 • Barista: Certainly. I'll enter the named menu drink so the bar follows the correct recipe.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I meant stronger in taste, and that distinction helped me choose.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Comparing drinks without overclaiming

In this fictional cafe, the small latte and small cappuccino both contain the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has more liquid milk. The customer wants less foam, not more caffeine. Compare the two using those facts.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you want a milky drink with less foam, not a caffeine estimate.

Second round: The customer asks whether a stronger taste guarantees more caffeine. Explain the limit.

Scenario 2 | Foam is the deciding factor

The menu offers two small milk drinks with the same stated espresso serving. One is described as having more foam. The customer wants that texture.

Role A: Barista: compare foam without promising caffeine content.

Role B: Customer: choose the foamier option after clarification.

Possible opening: Are you asking about the foam layer or the coffee amount?

Success checks

- Clarify lighter.
- Use this cafe's recipe descriptions.
- Read back the chosen drink.

Add a complication: The customer uses 'lighter' to mean airy texture, not lower caffeine.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

Clarify sweetness and allergy questions as separate issues.

SITUATION

A customer reports a milk allergy and asks for an oat latte without vanilla syrup. The barista knows oat drink is available but has not checked its current ingredients or shared-equipment arrangements. No claim of suitability can be made from the drink name.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

milk alternative - A plant-based drink offered instead of dairy milk, with ingredients varying by product.

syrup - A flavored liquid sweetener used in some cafe drinks.

sweetened - Containing added sweetening ingredients; the description may apply to a component or finished drink.

shared equipment - Equipment used for more than one product, relevant to questions about possible allergen cross-contact.

Useful word combinations

omit the syrup: leave out the flavored sweetener

check the carton: consult the actual product's current ingredient information

relay a milk-allergy concern: pass on the customer's stated allergy accurately

separate two requests: distinguish less sweetness from avoidance of an ingredient

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

A modification doesn't settle every concern

3. Notice the language

No syrup doesn't necessarily mean no added sweetener in other ingredients. A plant-based name doesn't resolve all ingredient or cross-contact questions.

Do you mean no syrup, or ___?

I can confirm ___ is available, but not yet ___.

Let me ask the lead about ___.

Compare this wording: Oat and no syrup means it's fine.

Clearer: I can record those choices, but your allergy question still needs checking.

The revised response doesn't confuse an order preference with suitability.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Leave out the vanilla, but keep the oat drink.

Barista: I'll ___.

A. reduce the syrup portion

B. replace the oat drink

C. omit the vanilla syrup

D. serve the syrup separately

2. Customer: Does no syrup mean the whole drink has no added sweetener?

Barista: The other ingredients ___ checked.

A. were previously

B. have already been

C. do not need to be

D. still need to be

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Oat is a choice, not a guarantee

The oat-latte question from the case.

01 • Customer: I have a milk allergy. Could I have an oat latte without vanilla syrup?

02 • Barista: I can note those choices, but I need to check the ingredients and equipment arrangements.

03 • Customer: Isn't using oat drink enough to answer that? I thought it replaced all dairy milk.

04 • Barista: It replaces the milk choice, but doesn't settle every ingredient or cross-contact question.

05 • Customer: Then please ask whoever can explain those details before you start making the drink.

06 • Barista: I'll ask our lead and keep the drink unmade while they check with you.

07 • Customer: Please also make sure the no-vanilla request stays attached to my order afterward.

08 • Barista: Certainly. That's separate from the allergy question; I won't lose that preference.

09 • Customer: Could I see the current oat carton information while we're waiting for the lead?

10 • Barista: I'll ask the lead to show you the product information and explain the remaining questions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

No syrup doesn't describe the carton

A customer clarifies what they mean by less sweet.

01 • Barista: You asked for unsweetened. Do you mean no syrup, or a particular milk product too?

02 • Customer: I mainly mean no syrup. I don't know whether the oat drink itself is sweetened.

03 • Barista: I'll show you the oat drink's ingredients. A milk alternative can contain sweeteners of its own.

04 • Customer: Please do. I'm choosing by taste, not asking you to make a medical recommendation.

05 • Barista: Understood. We can compare the listed options without promising how sweet each will taste to you.

06 • Customer: Then leave out the vanilla syrup and keep the oat product shown on this carton.

07 • Barista: I'll enter no vanilla syrup, not describe the complete drink as having no sweeteners.

08 • Customer: That's the distinction I needed. Please keep the drink size and coffee choice unchanged.

09 • Barista: Medium hot latte with oat drink, no vanilla syrup; the other choices stay as ordered.

10 • Customer: Yes. That gives me the change I asked for without guessing about the whole recipe.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Checking the actual product

A barista asks the lead about a customer's ingredient question.

01 • Barista: The customer asks whether our chocolate sauce contains milk. I haven't answered from memory.

02 • Lead: Which product are we using today? A similar bottle was delivered with a different label.

03 • Barista: This is the bottle at the bar, but I haven't compared its information with the delivery.

04 • Lead: Let's check this exact product. A previous brand's ingredient list won't settle today's question.

05 • Barista: The customer hasn't said whether it's an allergy or a preference. Shall I ask?

06 • Lead: Yes, ask directly and relay their words. Keep the ingredient check underway as well.

07 • Barista: I'll say we're checking today's sauce, not that removing whipped cream answers the question.

08 • Lead: Good. The topping and sauce are separate components, so both need their own accurate description.

09 • Barista: I'll leave the drink pending and bring back the customer's stated concern to you.

10 • Lead: Then I can discuss the current information with them before they decide what to order.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

A customer reports a milk allergy and asks for an oat latte without vanilla syrup. The barista knows oat drink is available but has not checked its current ingredients or shared-equipment arrangements. No claim of suitability can be made from the drink name.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: state the milk allergy and ask about shared equipment before choosing.

Second round: A colleague says plant-based always means suitable. Explain what that label doesn't establish.

Scenario 2 | A syrup is already in the base

A seasonal drink uses a premixed base that includes vanilla. The customer wants that drink with no vanilla. The lead confirms vanilla cannot be removed from this batch. A plain hot latte is available; the lead has checked its current ingredients and confirmed they contain no vanilla. It does not use the seasonal base. This ingredient check does not establish allergy suitability or rule out cross-contact.

Role A: Barista: explain the premixed base's limit and offer the plain hot latte as a different recipe, not an allergy-safe guarantee.

Role B: Customer: ask whether omitting a final syrup addition removes vanilla already in the base.

Possible opening: The base already contains vanilla; leaving out an extra addition wouldn't remove it.

Success checks

- Identify the premixed component.
- Avoid promising removal from the existing base.
- Ask whether the customer wants the plain hot latte without making an allergy-safety guarantee.

Add a complication: The customer thought 'no syrup' would change the entire recipe.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Managing the queue and pickup

Use a second identifier when names are duplicated.

SITUATION

Two customers named Sam have orders. Ticket 64 is a small hot latte and is complete. Ticket 67 is a large iced decaf latte and is in progress. The customer collecting 67 hears 'Sam' and reaches for 64. Clarify using ticket and drink details.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

order ticket - A printed or electronic record connecting a cafe order to its specifications and identifier.

pickup name - The name used to identify a completed order at the collection point.

mobile order - An order placed through a phone app or similar online ordering service.

order queue - The sequence of orders waiting for preparation or completion.

Useful word combinations

match the ticket number: compare the order identifier before collection

call the pickup name: announce the name linked to the completed order

check an order's status: find whether it is received, in progress, or complete

keep a grouped order together: connect drinks belonging to the same order

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Identify the order before handing it over

3. Notice the language

A pickup name may not be unique. Check drink specifications or the ticket number without requesting unrelated personal details.

Which ticket number are you collecting?

This is ____; your order is ____.

____ is complete, while ____ is in progress.

Compare this wording: Sam, here's yours.

Clearer: Sam, ticket sixty-four: small hot latte.

The ticket and drink distinguish customers with the same name.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: My ticket is sixty-seven, not sixty-four.

Barista: Yours is still ____.

A. the completed hot latte

B. collected

C. canceled

D. in progress

2. Barista: Could you tell me ____?

Customer: Sixty-seven.

A. what is your ticket number

B. what your ticket number is

C. what your number ticket is

D. what your ticket is number

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two Sams at the counter

The duplicated pickup name in the case.

01 • Customer: You called Sam. Is this my large iced decaf latte on ticket sixty-seven?

02 • Barista: This is a small hot latte on sixty-four, for another customer named Sam.

03 • Customer: Thanks for checking. I heard my name and didn't look closely at the drink.

04 • Barista: Your iced decaf is still in progress. I'll call Sam and sixty-seven together.

05 • Customer: Has my mobile order reached the bar, or should I show you the confirmation again?

06 • Barista: It's on the order queue as sixty-seven. You don't need to submit it again.

07 • Customer: All right. Can I wait over here without blocking the drinks being collected?

08 • Barista: Yes, that space is clear. I'll call sixty-seven and describe the drink as well.

09 • Customer: Please do. Two identical names made me think the first call was mine.

10 • Barista: Here's sixty-seven now: large iced decaf latte. Please compare that with your ticket before collection.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Received doesn't mean ready

A customer interprets a mobile confirmation.

01 • Customer: My phone says order received, but I can't see the drinks on the shelf.

02 • Barista: Received means the order reached us. It doesn't yet mean both drinks are ready.

03 • Customer: I thought the confirmation was a collection message. Can you check its current status?

04 • Barista: Certainly. What's the order number shown on that confirmation, rather than your payment details?

05 • Customer: It's eighty-five, under Morgan. There should be two drinks and one plain pastry.

06 • Barista: I see it. One drink is complete, while the second drink and pastry are pending.

07 • Customer: Would you like me to take the finished drink now and return for the rest?

08 • Barista: We can keep the order together if you prefer; tell me which arrangement works for you.

09 • Customer: Together, please. I'd rather collect once than risk forgetting one of the items.

10 • Barista: I'll keep the completed drink linked to eighty-five and call when the full order is ready.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A courier has a different number

A counter worker resolves a pickup-identifier mismatch.

01 • Courier: I'm collecting order thirty-two, but the bag here shows the customer's name without that number.

02 • Counter worker: Let's match the order before handing it over. What identifier does your pickup screen show?

03 • Courier: It shows cafe order one-thirty-two. I shortened that when I first spoke to you.

04 • Counter worker: Thanks. We also have a separate thirty-two, so the full number makes a difference.

05 • Courier: The one-thirty-two order should have three drinks. I don't need the other customer's details.

06 • Counter worker: Correct. This grouped order has three drinks and the matching full reference on its ticket.

07 • Courier: Can you confirm all three are part of this pickup, rather than separate counter orders?

08 • Counter worker: Yes, the ticket lists three, and all three are linked to one-thirty-two here.

09 • Courier: That matches my screen. I'll use the full number when I confirm collection.

10 • Counter worker: Thank you. I'll record this order as collected, leaving thirty-two's status unchanged.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Managing the queue and pickup

Two customers named Sam have orders. Ticket 64 is a small hot latte and is complete. Ticket 67 is a large iced decaf latte and is in progress. The customer collecting 67 hears 'Sam' and reaches for 64. Clarify using ticket and drink details.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you are Sam with ticket 67 and expect an iced drink.

Second round: The label is partly hidden. Check the ticket rather than guessing from the name.

Scenario 2 | Two out of three drinks ready

A customer ordered three drinks on ticket 48. Two are complete; the decaf is pending. The customer asks whether the whole order is ready.

Role A: Barista: state partial progress and offer grouped collection.

Role B: Customer: prefer to collect all three together.

Possible opening: Two drinks are ready; the decaf is still being prepared.

Success checks

- Identify the missing drink.
- Confirm grouped collection.
- Call the whole order only when complete.

Add a complication: A friend reaches for the two cups without knowing one drink remains.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Acknowledge the error and confirm the replacement details.

SITUATION

Ticket 22 requests a small iced latte with no syrup, but the cup label says hot vanilla latte. The customer hasn't collected it. A replacement is available; its wait hasn't been checked. Correct the mismatch without claiming a refund or a serving time.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

remake - A replacement drink made again to correct an order or preparation problem.

cup label - The printed or written drink information attached to a cup.

order modifier - A detail changing a drink's standard size, ingredient, or service choice.

texture - The way a drink feels in the mouth, such as smooth or foamy, as described by the customer.

Useful word combinations

acknowledge a mismatch: name the difference between the order and the drink

check the cup label: compare the written specification with the ticket

request a fresh remake: ask for a new drink with confirmed details

describe the customer's concern: repeat the issue without guessing its cause

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Fix the specification before the remake

3. Notice the language

Distinguish an incorrect label from a verified ingredient claim. The correct ticket supplies the requested drink, while the bar checks what happened.

The ticket says ____; the label says ____.

Would you still like ____?

I'll check the remake time before ____.

Compare this wording: That cup must be yours.

Clearer: This label doesn't match your ticket. Let's confirm the replacement details.

The response resolves the mismatch before handing over the cup.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: My ticket says iced, but this label says hot.

Barista: The label ____ your ticket.

A. matches

B. doesn't match

C. replaces

D. confirms

2. Customer: Is the replacement already made?

Barista: No, I've ____ it, but it isn't complete.

A. finished

B. requested

C. served

D. collected

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The label contradicts the ticket

The uncollected drink on ticket 22 from the case.

01 • Customer: This cup label says hot vanilla, but my ticket is for an iced latte without syrup.

02 • Barista: You're right. Those details don't match, and I'm sorry for the mix-up here.

03 • Customer: Please don't just change the writing on the cup. I want the drink I ordered.

04 • Barista: I'll request a fresh remake using the ticket details, then check the expected wait.

05 • Customer: Is it still going to be a small, or will the replacement size change?

06 • Barista: It stays small unless you request a change. Would you still like the original specifications?

07 • Customer: Yes: small iced latte, whole milk, and no syrup added to that drink.

08 • Barista: I've repeated those details to the bar. They estimate three minutes for the replacement.

09 • Customer: Thank you. I'll wait here, and please use my ticket number when you call it.

10 • Barista: I will. That's ticket twenty-two; I'll check the label against these details at pickup.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A taste complaint needs a question

A barista clarifies a drink concern without diagnosing the preparation.

01 • Customer: This latte tastes much sweeter than I expected. I can't tell what's different.

02 • Barista: I'm sorry it isn't what you expected. Did you request the version without vanilla syrup?

03 • Customer: Yes, and the label says no vanilla. I can't tell whether that's what was made.

04 • Barista: The label shows the request, but I'll ask the bar to check the preparation.

05 • Customer: Please don't tell me I'm imagining it. I just want the less-sweet drink I ordered.

06 • Barista: I understand. I'll describe the sweetness concern and confirm your preferred order for a remake.

07 • Customer: I'd like the same milk and size, with no vanilla added to the replacement.

08 • Barista: Understood. The milk itself has its listed ingredients; I won't promise the whole drink is unsweetened.

09 • Customer: That's fine. I'm only asking you to leave out the additional vanilla syrup.

10 • Barista: I'll relay that exact change and check the remake estimate with the bar.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A complaint about texture

A customer explains that foam, not coffee strength, is the issue.

01 • Barista: You said the drink wasn't right. Is the concern its temperature, flavor, or texture?

02 • Customer: The foam is the issue. I expected less of it when I ordered this latte.

03 • Barista: Thank you for explaining. You're not asking for more coffee or a different milk, correct?

04 • Customer: Correct. I'd like the same coffee and milk, with the foam request clarified to the bar.

05 • Barista: I'll ask which remake option they can offer under our drink menu today.

06 • Customer: Please check first. I don't want to wait for a drink that repeats the same problem.

07 • Barista: The bar can remake your latte with the less-foam request noted on the ticket.

08 • Customer: That works. Is the replacement already underway, or are you waiting for my decision?

09 • Barista: I was waiting for your choice. I'll confirm it now and ask for the estimated wait.

10 • Customer: Thanks. The texture was the problem; I'm happy to keep everything else the same.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Ticket 22 requests a small iced latte with no syrup, but the cup label says hot vanilla latte. The customer hasn't collected it. A replacement is available; its wait hasn't been checked. Correct the mismatch without claiming a refund or a serving time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: keep the original iced, no-syrup order and ask about the wait.

Second round: The bar offers a different size. Check whether the customer wants that change rather than assuming.

Scenario 2 | Wrong pickup, not wrong recipe

A customer's ticket is 18, but they are holding unconsumed drink 81. Both names are Alex. The customer's drink is still at the bar.

Role A: Barista: identify the mismatch and consult the lead about the wrongly collected drink.

Role B: Customer: confirm ticket 18 and ask for the correct drink.

Possible opening: Let's compare the full ticket number before discussing a recipe change.

Success checks

- Distinguish pickup error from recipe error.
- Locate the correct order.
- Refer handling of the collected drink to workplace practice without inventing steps.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to put drink 81 back on the pickup shelf.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Discussing coffee beans for home

Distinguish grind requirements and flavor descriptions from assumptions.

SITUATION

A customer buys a gift bag and asks for 'normal ground.' They don't know the recipient's brewer. This cafe sells the same coffee whole or ground. Grinding cannot be undone. The package's 'hazelnut' note describes flavor, not an ingredient statement.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

whole bean - Coffee sold as intact roasted beans rather than already ground.

grind size - The relative coarseness or fineness of ground coffee.

roast date - The date shown for when coffee was roasted, not when the package was purchased.

tasting notes - Descriptors suggesting a coffee's perceived flavors, not necessarily added ingredients.

Useful word combinations

ask about the brewer: identify the customer's coffee-making equipment

leave the beans whole: sell the coffee without grinding it

read the tasting notes: explain the package's flavor descriptions

confirm before grinding: check the chosen product and intended brewer before an irreversible change

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Clarify the brewer before changing the beans

3. Notice the language

A tasting note doesn't prove an ingredient is present or absent. Ask about the brewer; don't prescribe an unsupported grind when the equipment is unknown.

What kind of brewer do they use?

Would you prefer to leave the beans ___?

That phrase describes flavor, not ___.

Compare this wording: Normal ground will work for anything.

Clearer: Let's identify the brewer, or leave the bag whole while you check.

The question avoids an irreversible change based on an undefined request.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: I don't know the brewer yet, so please don't grind the coffee.

Barista: We can leave the beans ___ while you check.

- A. coarsely ground
- B. finely ground
- C. ground for espresso
- D. whole

2. Customer: Is the roast date the day I buy the bag?

Barista: No, it identifies when the coffee was ____.

- A. put on display
- B. roasted
- C. ordered by you
- D. ground for you

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Normal ground for an unknown brewer

The gift-bag purchase from the case.

01 • Customer: Could you grind this gift bag normally? I don't know much about their coffee maker.

02 • Barista: Which brewer does the recipient use? We need that detail before choosing a grind size.

03 • Customer: I'm not sure. I only know they make coffee at home every morning.

04 • Barista: Then we can leave the beans whole while you check, since grinding can't be undone.

05 • Customer: That sounds better. Does the hazelnut note mean hazelnut flavoring has been added?

06 • Barista: It's a tasting description, not an ingredient declaration. We can check the actual product information.

07 • Customer: Please do. I don't want to describe the gift incorrectly when I hand it over.

08 • Barista: I'll show you the package information and keep any ingredient question separate from the flavor notes.

09 • Customer: Thanks. I'll buy the whole-bean bag and ask about their brewer before requesting grinding.

10 • Barista: Certainly. I'll leave the package unchanged and confirm the whole-bean item at the till.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A roast date is not a purchase date

A customer compares a bag's roast date with the purchase date and asks about its printed storage guidance. No universal freshness guarantee is established.

01 • Customer: This sticker has a roast date, and my receipt will have today's date. Which describes the coffee?

02 • Barista: The roast date identifies when it was roasted. Today's receipt date records your purchase.

03 • Customer: I thought the older date meant the shop had already sold and returned this bag.

04 • Barista: No, that date alone doesn't indicate a return. It refers to the roasting event.

05 • Customer: Where are the storage instructions on the bag?

06 • Barista: They're printed here on the back, below the label.

07 • Customer: Please also confirm this is the whole-bean version, because the shelf had ground bags nearby.

08 • Barista: The package says whole bean. We haven't ground this bag or changed its contents.

09 • Customer: That's the one I want. I'll keep the dates separate when explaining it at home.

10 • Barista: I'll ring up the whole-bean bag, and your receipt will show today's purchase date.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A description, not an ingredient promise

A barista explains a coffee's chocolate tasting note.

01 • Customer: The label says chocolate notes. Does that mean this bag contains chocolate or milk?

02 • Barista: Those words describe perceived flavor. They don't by themselves tell us the complete ingredient information.

03 • Customer: I'm asking because I need to check ingredients, not because I want a sweeter taste.

04 • Barista: Then let's consult the product information for that question rather than interpret the tasting note.

05 • Customer: Can you also ask your lead about any information the label doesn't make clear?

06 • Barista: Certainly. I'll leave that question open until they can confirm what information we have.

07 • Customer: Would choosing the bag with citrus notes avoid the need for that ingredient check?

08 • Barista: No, a different flavor description wouldn't settle it. We'd still need the relevant product details.

09 • Customer: I'll wait for those details before choosing either bag, then. Please don't grind one yet.

10 • Barista: Of course. Both bags can stay as they are while we clarify your question.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Discussing coffee beans for home

A customer buys a gift bag and asks for 'normal ground.' They don't know the recipient's brewer. This cafe sells the same coffee whole or ground. Grinding cannot be undone. The package's 'hazelnut' note describes flavor, not an ingredient statement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you are buying a gift and don't know the brewer; decide whether to keep the bag whole.

Second round: The customer asks whether 'hazelnut notes' guarantees an ingredient is absent. Refer to actual product information.

Scenario 2 | Grinding request after checkout

A customer bought whole beans but now requests grinding. They say 'for a press' but mean either a French press or an espresso device. The bag has not been opened by staff.

Role A: Barista: ask which brewer they actually own.

Role B: Customer: you mean a French press with a plunger; explain when asked.

Possible opening: When you say press, which type of brewer do you mean?

Success checks

- Obtain a concrete brewer description.
- Repeat the understood equipment type.
- Check the cafe's grinding option before changing the product.

Add a complication: The customer calls both devices a coffee machine.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

State included items and additional charges before the customer commits.

SITUATION

A fictional cafe lists a latte at \$4, an oat-drink upcharge of \$0.50, and a pastry at \$3. The \$6 combo includes a standard latte and pastry; the oat upcharge still applies. Explain \$6.50 for that combo, versus \$7.50 separately, before payment.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

upcharge - An additional price for a specified change or extra item.

combo - A stated combination of items offered together at a listed price.

loyalty reward - A benefit available under a cafe's stated customer-reward conditions.

sold out - No longer available for purchase because the available stock has been used or sold.

Useful word combinations

quote the full drink price: state the price including selected changes

apply an eligible reward: use a benefit only when its stated conditions are met

offer the remaining choice: explain an available alternative to a sold-out item

separate item and offer prices: distinguish an individual price from a combination deal

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain the complete offer

3. Notice the language

An offer name doesn't specify every condition. Explain this fictional cafe's prices without implying all cafes charge the same way.

The combo includes ___ at ___.

The ___ upcharge still applies, making ___.

Separately, the same items total ___.

Compare this wording: It's six dollars, plus something.

Clearer: The oat latte and pastry combo totals six fifty.

The customer hears the complete selected-item price.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does oat drink change the six-dollar combo price?

Barista: With the fifty-cent upcharge, it's ____.

A. seven dollars

B. seven fifty

C. six dollars

D. six fifty

2. Customer: This is my first order today. If cinnamon has sold out, what can replace it?

Barista: Would you like the plain pastry ____?

A. instead

B. as well

C. again

D. too

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The upcharge remains in the combo

The fictional combo prices from the case.

- 01 • Customer:** Your sign says six dollars for a latte and pastry. Does that include oat drink?
- 02 • Barista:** The combo includes the standard latte; the fifty-cent oat upcharge still applies to that choice.
- 03 • Customer:** So my oat latte with this pastry would be six fifty altogether for those items?
- 04 • Barista:** Yes. The same selected items bought separately would total seven fifty on our menu.
- 05 • Customer:** Then the combo saves a dollar, not a dollar and fifty cents, correct?
- 06 • Barista:** Correct. Both versions include the same oat change, so the saving is one dollar.
- 07 • Customer:** I'll choose the combo. Please keep the drink size that qualifies for this offer.
- 08 • Barista:** Certainly. That's the listed small latte size; your oat choice stays on the ticket.
- 09 • Customer:** Thank you for explaining the upcharge before payment. I didn't see the small-print condition.
- 10 • Barista:** I'll enter the six-fifty combo and show you the item details before you pay.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A sold-out pastry is a choice point

A counter worker asks before substituting a pastry.

01 • Counter worker: The cinnamon pastry has just sold out. We still have plain pastries at the same price.

02 • Customer: I ordered cinnamon because of the flavor. Please don't just put a plain one in the bag.

03 • Counter worker: Of course. Would you like the plain alternative, another listed item, or no pastry today?

04 • Customer: No pastry, please. Can I keep the coffee order without the combo?

05 • Counter worker: Yes. I'll change it to the standalone coffee price and explain the revised total.

06 • Customer: Does that mean the coffee still costs its normal four dollars rather than the combo price?

07 • Counter worker: Correct. The standard coffee alone is four dollars, with no pastry included in that amount.

08 • Customer: That works. Please confirm the pastry has been removed before I make the payment.

09 • Counter worker: The ticket now shows one standard coffee only. There's no pastry or combo charge.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I wanted to choose, even though the alternative pastry cost the same.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A reward has a specific condition

A fictional reward covers a standard filter coffee, not all drinks.

01 • Customer: My account has a loyalty reward for a free drink. Does it cover a large specialty latte?

02 • Counter worker: The displayed reward here covers a standard filter coffee; it doesn't list the specialty latte.

03 • Customer: I thought free drink meant any drink. Can you show me the condition on the offer?

04 • Counter worker: Certainly. This line specifies the filter coffee and eligible size, rather than the whole menu.

05 • Customer: Could I pay only the difference for the latte, or is that not stated?

06 • Counter worker: That option isn't stated here. I'll ask the lead instead of inventing an exchange value.

07 • Customer: Please do. Don't use the reward while we're checking, because I may save it.

08 • Counter worker: Understood. It remains unused while the lead confirms whether any alternative arrangement is available.

09 • Customer: If there isn't one, I'll buy the latte normally and keep the reward for later.

10 • Counter worker: I'll confirm the lead's answer with you before choosing either option at the till.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

A fictional cafe lists a latte at \$4, an oat-drink upcharge of \$0.50, and a pastry at \$3. The \$6 combo includes a standard latte and pastry; the oat upcharge still applies. Explain \$6.50 for that combo, versus \$7.50 separately, before payment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: compare the oat combo with the separate prices and choose one.

Second round: The selected pastry sells out before payment. Ask whether the customer wants the remaining pastry; don't substitute silently.

Scenario 2 | A larger cup falls outside an offer

The fictional \$5 combo includes a small filter coffee and a plain pastry. A large coffee costs \$4 separately; the pastry costs \$3. No large-drink combo is listed.

Role A: Counter worker: explain the actual included size.

Role B: Customer: decide between the small combo and \$7 separate items.

Possible opening: The five-dollar combo uses the small coffee; would that size work for you?

Success checks

- Name the included size.
- State both complete choices.
- Get a choice before payment.

Add a complication: The customer assumes the large upgrade is free.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Handing over the bar and till

Hand over orders, supplies, and a till question without merging them.

SITUATION

At 2:00, ticket 108's coffee is complete but its tea is pending. Large takeaway lids are unavailable, though small lids remain. The outgoing worker counted the till, but the lead's reconciliation is pending. Assign the tea and stock follow-up without calling the till signed off.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

till - The cafe's sales register or the cash drawer associated with it.

cash float - The starting cash kept in a till to provide change.

reconciliation - A comparison of recorded transactions with counted money or other relevant records to identify differences.

stockout - A situation in which a needed product or supply is unavailable.

Useful word combinations

hand over the order queue: explain unfinished orders to the incoming barista

count the float: check the starting change cash without assuming sales totals

flag a till discrepancy: report a difference between the count and the record

report a stockout: name the exact unavailable product or supply

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Transfer three different statuses

3. Notice the language

Counting cash is not the same as reconciling it with records. Explain the specific stockout so the next worker doesn't assume every size is unavailable.

___ is complete; ___ remains on the queue.

We're out of ___, not ___.

I've counted ___; ___ is still pending.

Compare this wording: Everything's done except a few things.

Clearer: One tea remains on 108; large lids are out; till reconciliation is pending.

The incoming worker can identify separate actions.

4. Check the language

1. Incoming barista: Have all lid sizes run out?

Outgoing barista: No, the stockout affects ____.

- A. all packaging
- B. every cup size
- C. small lids only
- D. large lids only

2. Lead: Is the till reconciliation complete?

Worker: The cash is counted, but the comparison with records is ____.

- A. still pending
- B. already completed
- C. fully signed off
- D. no longer needed

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One tea, one stockout, one review

The 2:00 handover from the case.

01 • Outgoing worker: Ticket one-oh-eight has its coffee, but the tea is still waiting to be prepared.

02 • Incoming worker: I'll take the tea. Is that the only unfinished drink on the current order queue?

03 • Outgoing worker: Yes. Large takeaway lids are also out, although small lids are still available here.

04 • Incoming worker: I'll ask the lead about the large-lid stockout before offering a different packaging arrangement.

05 • Outgoing worker: Thanks. I've counted the till, but the reconciliation with the sales record is pending.

06 • Incoming worker: Are you keeping that review, or do you need me to take it over?

07 • Outgoing worker: I'll stay with it until the lead accepts the follow-up. You have the tea and lid query.

08 • Incoming worker: Understood. I won't call the till signed off simply because the count has been completed.

09 • Outgoing worker: Please let the customer know the tea is outstanding, so they don't leave with only coffee.

10 • Incoming worker: I will. I'll check their full order at pickup and ask about the lids next.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A float is not today's takings

A new counter worker clarifies the till count.

01 • Counter worker: The drawer count includes the cash float. Does the whole amount represent today's cash sales?

02 • Lead: No. The float is starting change cash, so keep it distinct from the transaction record.

03 • Counter worker: I haven't done the reconciliation yet. I was about to report the whole drawer as takings.

04 • Lead: Please describe it as the counted drawer amount until we've compared the appropriate records.

05 • Counter worker: There's also a difference between my count and the figure on this summary.

06 • Lead: Report the two figures without deciding whether it means a missed sale or another issue.

07 • Counter worker: I'll bring you the count and the summary, with the cause of the difference unconfirmed.

08 • Lead: Good. Don't assign blame or invent an adjustment to make the numbers appear to match.

09 • Counter worker: Will you take the reconciliation review while I return to the counter orders?

10 • Lead: Yes, I've accepted that review. I'll ask you for any clarification about your count.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which cup size is actually missing?

A barista clarifies a supply shortage before updating the counter.

01 • Barista: You said we're out of cups. Which size and service type does that affect?

02 • Counter colleague: Large takeaway cups only. The small takeaway cups and dine-in mugs are still stocked.

03 • Barista: Thanks. I'll tell the counter the exact size rather than describe every drink as unavailable.

04 • Counter colleague: Please ask the lead about the available service choices before promising a substitute container.

05 • Barista: I will. A customer may prefer a different size, but we should ask them first.

06 • Counter colleague: Exactly. Their choice could change the order and price, so don't silently swap the size.

07 • Barista: I'll check the permitted options and explain them before the customer decides whether to order.

08 • Counter colleague: Meanwhile, I'll count the small cups so our update includes the stock we actually have.

09 • Barista: Good. Please report that count when it's complete, not an estimate from looking at the sleeve.

10 • Counter colleague: I'll do that. The confirmed shortage remains large takeaway cups, with the small-cup count pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over the bar and till

At 2:00, ticket 108's coffee is complete but its tea is pending. Large takeaway lids are unavailable, though small lids remain. The outgoing worker counted the till, but the lead's reconciliation is pending. Assign the tea and stock follow-up without calling the till signed off.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Incoming worker: accept the tea follow-up and large-lid query; ask who retains the till review.

Second round: A coworker says the till 'looks about right.' Keep the unresolved record comparison explicit.

Scenario 2 | A pickup has no completion mark

Ticket 120 shows two coffees but no collection status. The cups aren't on the shelf. The outgoing worker didn't witness pickup; the lead can check the order history.

Role A: Outgoing worker: report what you know and don't know.

Role B: Incoming worker: accept the status check without marking collected from appearance alone.

Possible opening: I can't confirm whether ticket 120 was collected.

Success checks

- Separate shelf observation from pickup confirmation.
- Identify ticket 120.
- Assign the check and preserve uncertain status.

Add a complication: A colleague assumes an empty shelf proves collection.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Taking a precise drink order

Editing example: Do you mean our regular size, and would you like caffeinated or decaf coffee?

The check separates size from coffee choice.

Check 1: C - size

A: The customer hasn't chosen milk here.

B: No sweetness choice is stated.

C: Correct. The customer uses 'middle' to identify the size.

D: The customer explicitly separates size from the coffee type.

Check 2: D - coffee with most caffeine removed

A: This overstates decaf as necessarily containing zero caffeine.

B: A smaller serving doesn't make regular coffee decaffeinated.

C: Adding milk changes the drink, not the coffee's decaffeination status.

D: Correct. Decaffeination removes most caffeine without guaranteeing complete absence.

Model response: When you say regular, do you mean our middle size or caffeinated coffee? I'll check those separately so I enter the right drink. Would you like the latte hot or iced, and which milk would you prefer? Once those details are clear, I'll repeat the full order before sending it to the bar.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Comparing drinks without overclaiming

Editing example: Color doesn't establish caffeine content; I can compare our stated recipes.

The revision replaces an unsupported inference with a bounded comparison.

Check 1: A - latte

A: Correct. This matches the two milk drinks in the stated recipe comparison.

B: An Americano is espresso with water, not this milk-rich option.

C: Black filter coffee doesn't contain the milk described here.

D: The cappuccino cannot differ from itself in this comparison.

Check 2: B - but

A: This makes the difference a condition.

B: Correct. 'But' contrasts two compatible facts.

C: Different milk texture doesn't cause the equal espresso serving.

D: The contrast isn't a necessary consequence.

Model response: In our small drinks, both choices use the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam, while the latte has more liquid milk. Since you're asking for less foam rather than more coffee, the latte sounds closer to that preference. I wouldn't use how strong it tastes as an exact measure of caffeine.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

Editing example: I can record those choices, but your allergy question still needs checking.

The revised response doesn't confuse an order preference with suitability.

Check 1: C - omit the vanilla syrup

A: Reducing leaves some syrup instead of omitting it entirely.

B: The customer specifically asked to retain the oat drink.

C: Correct. This removes only the requested vanilla component.

D: Separate syrup would still include an item the customer declined.

Check 2: D - still need to be

A: No earlier check of those ingredients is established in this exchange.

B: The scenario doesn't establish that those checks occurred.

C: Other components may have their own sweetening ingredients.

D: Correct. Omitting syrup doesn't establish every component's ingredients.

Model response: I can note oat drink and no vanilla syrup, but those changes don't by themselves establish suitability for your milk allergy. I need to check the current product information and ask our lead about shared equipment. Let's leave the drink unmade while we get those details, so you can decide with accurate information.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Managing the queue and pickup

Editing example: Sam, ticket sixty-four: small hot latte.

The ticket and drink distinguish customers with the same name.

Check 1: D - in progress

A: The completed hot latte belongs to sixty-four.

B: No collection is reported for this ticket.

C: The ticket remains active, not canceled.

D: Correct. The iced decaf order is being prepared.

Check 2: B - what your ticket number is

A: Indirect questions use statement word order after the question phrase.

B: Correct. The subject precedes its verb in this embedded question.

C: The noun phrase should be 'ticket number'.

D: The word 'number' belongs with 'ticket' before the verb.

Model response: Are you collecting ticket sixty-seven, the large iced decaf latte? This completed drink is a small hot latte on sixty-four for another Sam. Your order is still in progress. I'll use the ticket number as well as the name when I call it, so the two orders don't get mixed up.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Editing example: This label doesn't match your ticket. Let's confirm the replacement details.

The response resolves the mismatch before handing over the cup.

Check 1: B - doesn't match

A: The two temperature styles conflict in the scenario.

B: Correct. This identifies the observed inconsistency between records.

C: A conflicting label doesn't replace the customer's order.

D: The label contradicts rather than confirms the ticket.

Check 2: B - requested

A: Finished contradicts the statement that it isn't complete.

B: Correct. Requesting a remake precedes its completion.

C: Serving means handing it over, which hasn't happened.

D: Collection would place the drink after preparation.

Model response: The cup label doesn't match your ticket: you ordered a small iced latte with no syrup, but this label says hot vanilla. I'm sorry for that mix-up. I'll request a fresh drink with your confirmed details and check the wait before giving you an estimate. Is the original order still what you'd like?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Discussing coffee beans for home

Editing example: Let's identify the brewer, or leave the bag whole while you check.

The question avoids an irreversible change based on an undefined request.

Check 1: D - whole

A: A coarse grind still makes an irreversible change now.

B: A fine grind assumes a requirement that hasn't been established.

C: An espresso grind assumes a brewer the customer hasn't identified.

D: Correct. Whole beans preserve the later choice of grinding.

Check 2: B - roasted

A: Display timing isn't the meaning of roast date.

B: Correct. The term names the roasting event's date.

C: The customer's order date is a different event.

D: Grinding and roasting are separate events in production.

Model response: Could you tell me what kind of brewer the recipient uses? There isn't one grind described as normal for every brewer, and grinding can't be undone. We can leave this bag whole while you check. Also, the hazelnut tasting note describes a flavor impression; it isn't the ingredient information for an allergy question.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

Editing example: The oat latte and pastry combo totals six fifty.

The customer hears the complete selected-item price.

Check 1: D - six fifty

A: That adds one dollar rather than fifty cents.

B: That is the separate-item total, not the combo total.

C: This leaves out the stated oat-drink upcharge.

D: Correct. Six dollars plus fifty cents is six fifty.

Check 2: A - instead

A: Correct. 'Instead' offers the plain pastry as a substitute.

B: 'As well' adds an item rather than replacing the unavailable one.

C: 'Again' implies a repeat order, unlike this first order.

D: 'Too' also signals addition rather than the requested replacement.

Model response: The standard latte-and-pastry combo is six dollars. Your oat-drink choice adds fifty cents, so that combination is six fifty. Bought separately, the four-dollar latte, fifty-cent change, and three-dollar pastry would total seven fifty. The combo saves one dollar for these items; shall I enter that option with the oat choice?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Handing over the bar and till

Editing example: One tea remains on 108; large lids are out; till reconciliation is pending.

The incoming worker can identify separate actions.

Check 1: D - large lids only

A: The shortage doesn't cover all packaging supplies.

B: The case preserves stock of small lids.

C: Small lids remain available in this case.

D: Correct. Only large takeaway lids are reported unavailable.

Check 2: A - still pending

A: Correct. Counting alone doesn't complete the required comparison.

B: The case says that comparison hasn't been completed.

C: No completed review or sign-off has been given.

D: Counting doesn't remove the need to compare the records.

Model response: Ticket one-oh-eight still needs its tea; the coffee is complete. Large takeaway lids are out, but small lids remain. Can you take the tea order and confirm the large-lid situation with the lead? I've counted the till, but reconciliation isn't complete. I'll stay responsible for that review until the lead takes it.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Food and Beverage Serving and Related Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/food-preparation-and-serving/food-and-beverage-serving-and-related-workers.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Baristas

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/35-3023.01>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Baristas and Cafe Staff English

Professional audience: Baristas, cafe counter staff, and coffee pickup staff

Scope: All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

Lesson 01: Taking a precise drink order

Original fictional case: A customer says 'a regular latte.' This cafe uses regular for its middle size, but the customer might mean caffeinated coffee or the usual milk. No drink has been made. Clarify size, hot or iced, and coffee choice separately.

Language workshop: Unpack the word 'regular'

Communication goal: Clarify a familiar word that can describe several order details.

Language guidance: Ask one specification at a time. Decaf describes coffee, not milk or sweetness, and doesn't mean guaranteed zero caffeine.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): By regular, do you mean ___? / Would you like that hot or ___? / That's a ___ latte with ___, for ___.

Vocabulary: espresso: A concentrated coffee drink prepared by passing hot water through finely ground coffee under pressure. / shot: A cafe's specified serving of espresso; exact size and recipe vary. / decaf: Coffee from which most caffeine has been removed; it is not necessarily caffeine-free. / dine in: An order intended to be consumed in the cafe rather than taken away.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you mean middle size; choose hot, decaf, and whole milk when asked.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The customer says 'the normal one' about milk. Ask for the actual milk choice.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: When you say regular, do you mean our middle size or caffeinated coffee? I'll check those separately so I enter the right drink. Would you like the latte hot or iced, and which milk would you prefer? Once those details are clear, I'll repeat the full order before sending it to the bar.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT